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UC ADMISSIONS BY ETHNICITY

Before and After the Removal of the SAT/ACTs

“How does the removal of the SAT/ACT requirements effect admission rates by ethnicity?”



HISTORY

Standardized test scores (SAT/ACT) were once a core part of the University of California admissions decisions. A 2020 court ruling barred UC from considering SAT/ACT scores starting with the Fall 2021 cycle, and the policy was made permanent (test-blind) for the years that followed. That shift, layered on top of the COVID-19 disruption to testing access in 2020, creates a natural before/after comparison.

HOW ARE WE ANSWERING THIS QUESTION?

To answer this question we decided to analyze the UC Admissions data by ethnicity (applying and acceptance) in three chunks of time: pre 2019 (pre covid), 2020-2021 (covid), 2022 and onwards (after test-blindness policy).

DEVELOPING OUR DASHBOARD

BRAINSTORMING

We first started with brainstorming what question we should answer. Some of our initial ideas include

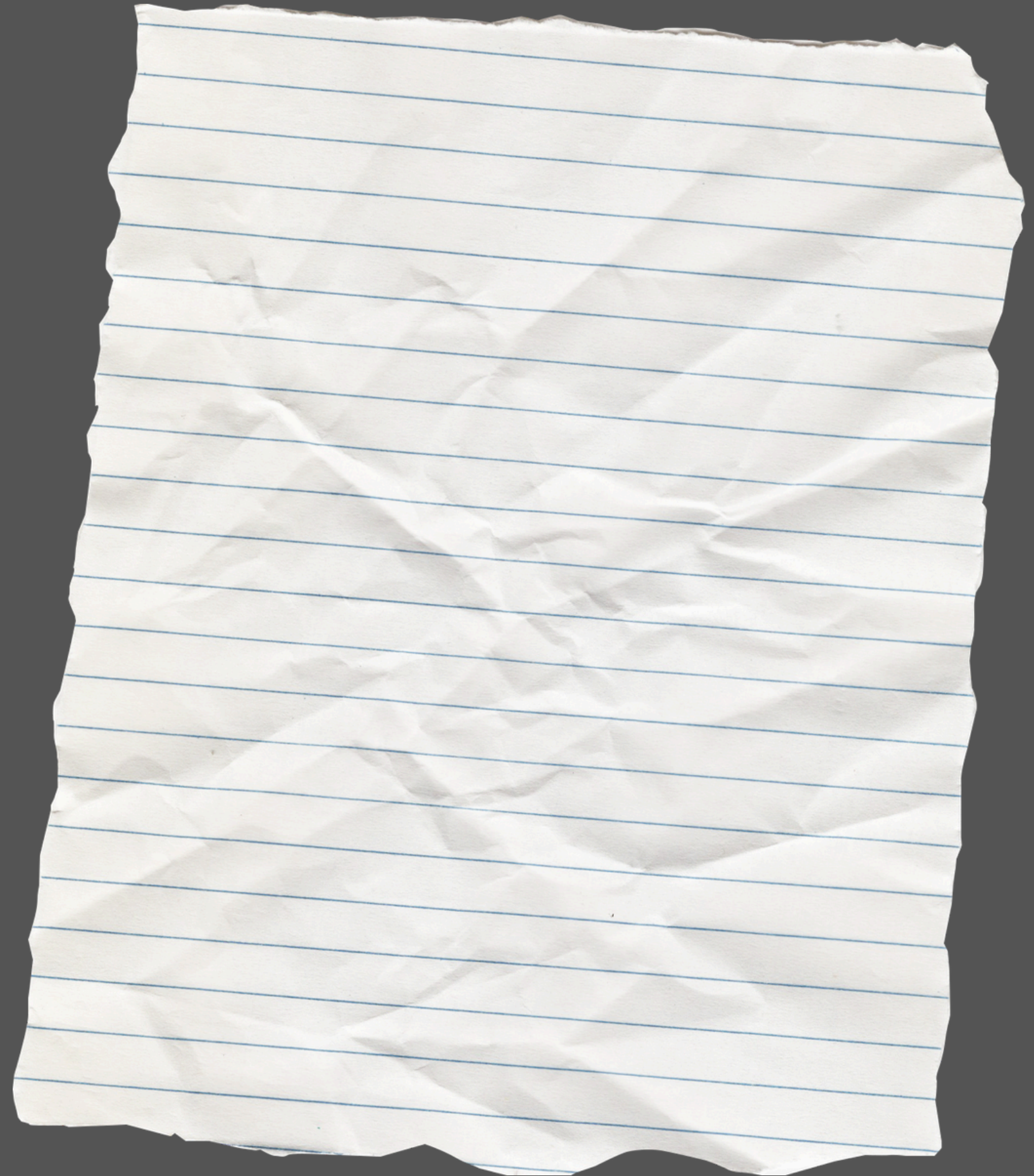
- For transfer students to UCs in 2025, which specific majors are the most and least competitive by college?
- Which California/Bay Area regions have the highest application, admission, and enrolling rates to the UCs?
- Do Bay Area private schools consistently outperform traditional public schools in UC admit rates ?

STEP 2

PAPER

After determining our question we began fleshing out our dashboard on paper?

Here we determined how we wanted our site to look and what data we wanted to include in our dashboard.



STEP 3

PUBLISH

We started by hard coding the dashboard on HTML. We later used Gemini as a way to improve the front-end of the dashboard (visuals; making it look prettier). However, we were unsure how to create this code into a working site so we later used Claude to create a public link.



CONCLUSIONS

We concluded the fact that there is, in fact, NO CORRELATION between the test-blindness policy and the admission rates by ethnicity.

Although there is still a disparity between different ethnicities, this was not because of the removal of SAT/ACT in admission considerations. In fact, all ethnicity maintained a similar trend throughout the time periods sampled.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME

Please ask us if you have any questions